IELTS FOUNDATION · UNIT 6

Transport and Places in Town

Getting around, finding places and comparing them

Vocabulary | Grammar | Reading | Listening | Writing | Speaking

Mindset for IELTS Foundation · Unit 6 · Book pp. 70–79

LEARNING GOAL

Talk and write about places in town and getting around, and compare them

Objectives: you will…

- name types of transport and places in a town
- read signs, notices and messages for the main message
- listen for names, numbers, days and prices
- use comparatives and superlatives
- speak about transport and towns
- write a longer piece of continuous writing

Success criteria: I can…

- say where places are (next to, opposite, between)
- find the main message, not just similar words
- spell names and write numbers correctly
- use -er / -est, more / the most, better / best
- give longer answers with topic words
- write about 100 words with if, so, because

IELTS STRATEGIES

Test habits to build in this unit

READING

Read the whole short text. Work out the **main idea** and the **key words**. Options with **similar words** may not match the meaning.

box, p. 71 · Mini tips 06.1–06.2, p. 72

LISTENING

Read the questions **first**. Expect a day, a price, a spelling, a number or a postcode. Practise the **alphabet**.

box, p. 73

SPEAKING

Show the **vocabulary and grammar** for the topic. Don’t give very short answers.

Tip 17, p. 75

LEAD-IN

Famous places quiz

a tower

Which city has the Eiffel Tower?

a bridge

Where is the Golden Gate Bridge?

a temple

Which country has Angkor Wat?

What is the most famous place in your town? How do people get there?

VOCABULARY

Places in a city, travel and transport

Places in a city

square · library · post office · police station · department store · sports centre · car park · museum

Travel and transport

motorway · coach · platform · ticket · the underground · flight · motorbike · bicycle

What do you do there? Make a sentence: “You can borrow books at the library.”

READING · SHORT REAL-WORLD TEXTS

What is the main message?

SWIMMING POOL

Children under 8 must swim with an adult. Lifeguard on duty 9am–6pm.

A Children under 8 can’t swim after 6pm.

B Young children need an adult with them in the pool.

C Adults must stay with the lifeguard.

IELTS STRATEGY

Work out the **main idea** and the key words.

All the options use **similar words**. Choose the one with the same **meaning**.

LISTENING · GAP-FILL

Read the questions first

Name: Mr _____ → a spelling

Open late on: _____ → a day

Ticket: £_____ → a price

Postcode: _____ → letters and numbers

IELTS STRATEGY

Read the questions first so you know what to listen for.

Practise the **alphabet**: H, J, G, E, I, A, R are often confused.

LISTENING AND SPEAKING · DIRECTIONS

Where is it?

next to
right beside it

opposite
on the other side, facing it

between
in the middle of two places

in front of / behind
at the front / at the back

on the left / right of
on one side

Ask a partner
“Where’s the bank?” “It’s between…”

GRAMMAR · FORM AND USE

Comparatives and superlatives

Adjective	Comparative (+ than)	Superlative (the…)
one syllable: cheap	cheaper	the cheapest
CVC: big, hot	bigger, hotter	the biggest, the hottest
two syllables + y: busy	busier	the busiest
longer: expensive	more expensive	the most expensive
irregular: good / bad / far	better / worse / further	the best / worst / furthest

Never both: not “more cheaper” or “the most biggest”.

GRAMMAR · PRACTICE

Which is better: bus, train or bike?

	Bus	Train	Bike
Time to school	35 minutes	15 minutes	25 minutes
Cost per day	£2	£4	£0
Comfort	crowded	comfortable	tiring in the rain

Make 3 sentences: “The train is **faster than** the bus.” “The bike is **the cheapest**.” Which would you choose? **Why?**

GRAMMAR · COMMON MISTAKES

Find the mistake

× Mistake	✓ Correct	Why
The train is **more fast** than the bus.	The train is **faster** than the bus.	short adjective: -er
It’s the **most biggest** city.	It’s the **biggest** city.	never more / most + -er / -est
London is **expensiver** than Leeds.	London is **more expensive** than Leeds.	long adjective: more
My town is **gooder** than yours.	My town is **better** than yours.	irregular: good – better
She is taller **that** me.	She is taller **than** me.	comparative + than

Find the mistake, say the rule, then write the correct sentence.

SPEAKING · PAIR TALK

Transport and your hometown

Student A asks

How did you travel here today?

Is traffic a problem in your town?

What is the best way to travel in your town?

Student B asks

Where do you come from?

What is the oldest part of your town?

How could you make your town better?

IELTS STRATEGY Show the **vocabulary and grammar** connected with the topic. Try not to give very short answers.

WRITING · A LONGER EMAIL

Answer every question Sandy asks

"I'm coming to your country next month on holiday. Where do you think I should go and why are those places interesting? What's the best way for me to travel around?"

1 · Where?
Two or three places

2 · Why?
A reason with **because**

3 · How?
Best transport, compared

Plan notes first · about **100 words** · linkers: **if, so, because, after that**

WRITING · MODEL

A model email (about 100 words)

Hi Sandy,

I’m really pleased you’re coming to visit my country. The first place you should visit is the old city, **because** it has the **most beautiful** temples. **After that**, go to the river market. It is **busier** in the morning, **so** arrive early. **If** you like nature, the national park is **quieter than** the city and the views are amazing.

The **best** way to travel is by train. It is **cheaper than** a taxi and **more comfortable than** the bus. The station is next to the market, so you can walk there in five minutes.

See you soon,
Mai

YOUR TURN

Make your answers longer

SHORT

“By bus.”

LONGER

“I came by bus, because it’s cheaper than a taxi. The bus stop is opposite my house, so it’s easy.”

Answer + reason + one more detail. Now ask your partner the Ex 18 questions again.

REVIEW

Can you…?

- ✓ name places in town and what you do there
- ✓ find the main message of a sign or notice
- ✓ catch spelled names, numbers, days and prices
- ✓ say where places are on a map
- ✓ compare with comparatives and superlatives
- ✓ write an email of about 100 words

Next: the Unit 6 Challenge on the Miss L Gems site.